26900278 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026

Fifth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCHIS301 - HISTORIOGRAPHY I - THE INHERITANCE

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answer Questions

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1.	Who was Polybius?	[U] / [CO1, CO2]
2.	What is meant by Indo-Persian historiography?	[U] / [CO1]
3.	Describe the role of the 'suta' or bard in preserving genealogical and historical memory.	[U] / [CO1]
4.	'Decline of the West'	[U] / [CO3]
5.	What is Enlightenment history writing?	[U] / [CO1]
6.	Analyse how Julius Caesar's 'Commentaries' served his political interests.	[An] / [CO2]
7.	Auguste Comte's 'Law of Three Stages'	[U] / [CO4]
8.	How does the legal and political superstructure serve to preserve the economic base?	[U] / [CO4]
9.	Define Hegelian dialectics.	[U] / [CO4]

10. Explain the specific constitutional function of the Monarch (der Fürst) in Hegel's rational state. [U] / [CO4]

11. Analyse the function historical records served in legitimising a new ruling dynasty in China. [An] / [CO2]

12. Write a short note on Augustine's philosophy of history. [U] / [CO1]

[2x10 = 20]

Part B

Short Essay Questions

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

13. Describe the cyclical conception of time in pre-classical thought. [U] / [CO1, CO2]

14. Explain how the concept of Alienation (Entfremdung) illustrates the human cost of capitalist historical progress in Marx's early writings. [U] / [CO4]

15. Write a short note on Giambattista Vico. [U] / [CO1]

16. Explain Descartes' method of doubt. [U] / [CO1]

17. Discuss the main features of Persian historiographical traditions in the Middle East. [U] / [CO1]

18. Discuss the influence of Christian theology on medieval historical writing. [An] / [CO2]

19. Examine the role of empathy (Einfuhlung) in Ranke's method of historical reconstruction. [An] / [CO4]

20. Compare how Greek and Roman historians treated major military defeats within their respective national narratives. [An] / [CO2]

21. Explain the significance of the Funeral Oration. [U] / [CO1, CO2]

22. Analyse the relationship between society and historical change in Ibn Khaldun's thought. [An] / [CO1]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essay Questions

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **10** marks

23. Describe the major characteristics of Speculative Philosophy of History. [U] / [CO1]

24. Critically evaluate the evolution of historical determinism from Hegel's dialectical idealism and Marx's historical materialism to the sociological [E] / [CO3, CO4]

interventions of Durkheim and Weber. To what extent did the sociological turn dismantle the belief in inevitable historical laws

25. Assess the significance of the idealist tradition for the subsequent development of the philosophy of history in the nineteenth century. [E] / [CO3]

26. Evaluate Herder's contribution to the development of the philosophy of history. [E] / [CO1]

[10x2 = 20]